THE AI GARAGE

2D POV History Style Guide

Original 2D cartoon art direction for reusable visual planning

STYLE GOAL

Create original, emotionally readable history cartoons with bold ink outlines, oversized expressive eyes and clear period settings. The style can be reused across episodes without copying any other creator's characters or thumbnail designs.

01

FACES & EMOTION

Huge white circular eyes, small pupils, thick eyebrows and strong but simple mouth shapes.

02

INK & SHADING

Heavy charcoal outlines with readable cel shading and restrained printed texture.

03

HISTORICAL WORLDS

Era-appropriate costumes and props, immersive backgrounds, strong foreground depth.

04

PRODUCTION RULES

Single-scene stills, fixed character references and a consistency gate before motion.

PALETTE DIRECTION



Pale face | Dark ink | Earth | Olive | Smoke | Muted red | Warm stone

Original, AI-generated sample scenes and character notes begin on page 2.
No third-party channel thumbnail screenshots are included in this PDF.

1. Core Visual Language

Use the example frame below as the benchmark for **line quality, facial proportions, rendering simplicity, and emotional clarity**. The goal is a stylized animated-history frame, not realism.



Face Design	Line & Shading
Pale, almost gray-white skin. Very large circular white eyes with tiny pupils. Dark under-eye accents and expressive brows. Mouths are simple but dramatic: worried, shouting, tense, or stunned.	Use bold black outlines around characters and props. Interior linework stays clean. Apply simple cel shading plus light texture or dirt only where useful. Keep readability higher than detail.
Silhouette Priority	**Emotion Priority**
Each character should read instantly from silhouette: helmet type, cap, officer shoulders, backpack shape, rifle length, map table, etc.	Every scene should communicate one main emotion within one second: fear, confusion, dread, tension, pride, or authority.

2. Character System

This style works best when scenes are built around **clear status contrast**: vulnerable main character vs powerful institution / superior / battlefield force.





Main Character: Usually one young, overwhelmed, pale-faced protagonist with large eyes, visible fear or confusion, and readable body language.

Authority Figure: Officer, commander, boss, or historical superior. Cleaner posture, more angular brows, confident smirk or stern stare.

Support Cast: Background soldiers, aides, cooks, workers, or civilians should stay simpler and slightly less contrasty than the lead.

Pose Rules: Hands, props, and shoulders should reinforce the emotion. Avoid neutral pose unless the scene intentionally needs calm.

Prop Rules: Use one iconic prop per shot when possible: rifle, map, scroll, shovel, lantern, banner, or supply crate.

Recommended recurring expressions for a character sheet: worried, stunned, angry, determined, suspicious, relieved.

3. Color & Environment Rules

Environments should feel historical, textured, and dramatic — but the characters must remain the strongest focal point.

Suggested palette direction

#261E18 38, 30, 24	#5D5A5B 93, 90, 91	#513023 81, 48, 35	#8E7254 142, 114, 84
#999AA2 153, 154, 162	#E3E0E2 227, 224, 226	#A98C66 169, 140, 102	#717986 113, 121, 134

Palette Logic	Environment Design
Use muted base tones. Reserve stronger reds, golds, or firelight for focal contrast. Skin stays pale so the face pops against muddy or smoky backgrounds.	Backgrounds should show era clearly: trenches, ruins, kitchens, command rooms, castles, supply areas, fields, or civic interiors. Use perspective lines and foreground framing for depth.
Lighting	**Composition**
Blend cool gray sky light with one warmer source when helpful: lanterns, candles, explosions, hearths, windows, or torchlight.	Use one dominant focal face plus a readable secondary element. Thumbnail-friendly compositions usually place the main face large on the left or right third.

4. Prompting Guide

Use this structure to keep generations consistent across thumbnails, still frames, and character references.

Master style phrase
Original 2D illustrated POV-history cartoon, thick black outlines, pale expressive face, oversized round white eyes with tiny pupils, heavy eyebrows, clean cel shading, muted historical color palette, readable props, detailed but clear environment, emotionally dramatic composition, 16:9.

Character prompt template
Create an original [role] in the approved POV-history cartoon style: [age/gender], [emotion], [costume], [iconic prop], pale skin, oversized eyes, thick outline, readable silhouette, 16:9, plain background or lightly contextual background.

Scene prompt template
Create an original 2D cartoon scene in the approved POV-history style. Show [character] in [historical setting] doing [action]. Emphasize [emotion]. Use muted browns/greens/grays, thick outlines, oversized eyes, clean cel shading, readable historical props, and a strong focal composition. No text.

Negative prompt ideas
Avoid photorealism, glossy 3D rendering, anime eyes, painterly brushwork, over-detailed skin texture, modern props, cluttered composition, low-contrast faces, tiny unreadable characters, or soft blurry outlines.

- Lock the character design before generating full scenes.
- Generate all stills first when building a video engine.
- Check face shape, eye size, outfit, and prop continuity before animation.
- Keep motion prompts simple: eye shift, small hand motion, slow camera push, subtle environmental movement.
- If a scene becomes too realistic or loses line quality, regenerate before moving on.

5. Quality Checklist

DO	AVOID
• Make the face the fastest-readable element in the frame.	• Do not copy exact thumbnails, captions, or competitor characters.
• Use exaggerated emotion and a clear single-story moment.	• Do not flatten every scene to the same camera angle.
• Keep historical props and costumes recognizable but stylized.	• Do not let the background outshine the protagonist.
• Use muted palettes with one or two contrast accents.	• Do not mix this style with realistic lighting or painterly rendering.
• Design backgrounds with depth but avoid noise around the face.	• Do not animate before the still batch passes consistency review.

FRAME APPROVAL CHECKLIST

■ Face matches style bible

■ Eyes are large, round, and readable

■ Outline weight feels bold and consistent

■ Palette stays muted and historical

■ Emotion is obvious at thumbnail size

■ Scene contains one focal action

■ Props and setting support the era

■ Final still is safe to animate

Prepared from your attached reference visuals plus original sample frames created to demonstrate the style system. Use this guide as the design source for your 2D Animation Guide PDF, scene prompting, and QC process.